Zamp

Engineering Interview

Overview

This is an open-ended project round. You'll be given a problem statement — it's intentionally vague. How you interpret, scope, and build it is the evaluation. We're not looking for the right answer. We're looking for how you think, what decisions you make, and whether you can turn ambiguity into something real.

We believe engineers are builders. That means we care about the full picture — your code, your product instincts, your UX choices, your documentation. Not just whether it works, but whether it's insanely great.

Treat it like a real work assignment, not an exam.

What we expect from you

- A working, deployed solution
- A README explaining what you built, why you scoped it the way you did, and how to set it up
- A public GitHub repository with your code

What we evaluate

Criteria	What this means
Problem framing	How did you interpret the problem? Why did you scope it the way you did? What did you deliberately leave out and why?
Product thinking	Did you think about who this is for and what problem it actually solves? Or did you just write code?
UX decisions	Does the experience make sense? Is it intuitive? We're not judging visual polish — we're judging whether you thought about the person using this.
Code quality	Is the code clean, well-organised, and something you'd be comfortable handing to a teammate?

Tests	Are there meaningful tests? Not token coverage — tests that actually catch real problems.
Documentation	Could someone set this up and understand your thinking without talking to you?
Setup experience	How easy is it to get running?
Velocity	Given 5 days, how much real progress did you make?
Above and beyond	Did you surprise us? Not with bells and whistles, but with depth. Did you solve a hard sub-problem that most people would skip?

Tools

Use whatever language, framework, or tools you want. AI tools (Cursor, Copilot, ChatGPT) are fully encouraged — we use them every day.

Clarifications

If you find yourself wanting to ask "what exactly do you mean by X?" — that's the point. The ambiguity is intentional. Define it yourself, make a call, and move forward. Your interpretation is part of the evaluation.

Problem Statements

Pick one of the three problems below. Choose whichever one you find more interesting.

01

Turn messy documents into structured, queryable data

Build a system that takes unstructured or semi-structured documents and converts them into clean, structured data that can be searched and queried.

02

Learn a user's process by watching them, then do it for them

Build a system that can observe how a user performs a task, learn the pattern, and then automate it on their behalf.

03

Build a conversational agent

Build a conversational agent that can help a user accomplish a real task. What task, what user, and how good the experience is — that's your call.

The ambiguity is intentional — define it yourself and move forward. Submit your solution via the provided website link.